

Your Pet Has an Ear Hematoma

A guide for your pet's recovery at home

Your pet was diagnosed with an aural hematoma — a pocket of blood collected inside the ear flap — while in our care at the shelter, and treatment was started. Refer to your adoption paperwork for your pet's specific treatment and medications.

What to Expect

- An aural hematoma is a blood-filled swelling of the ear flap. It is not a cancer or infection — it is similar to a large bruise.
- It's often caused by an underlying ear infection, allergies, or vigorous head shaking or scratching. Treating that underlying cause is just as important as treating the hematoma itself.
- Healing can take several weeks. Some thickening or wrinkling of the ear flap is common even with treatment — this is normal scar tissue.

Home Care

- Give all medications exactly as directed.
- The e-collar must stay on at all times when unsupervised to prevent scratching or shaking.
- Keep the ear clean and dry — no baths or swimming during recovery.
- Do not apply pressure to the ear flap or attempt to drain it at home.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Pet Has:

- The ear flap becomes more swollen or refills after draining
- Increased redness, warmth, or a foul odor from the ear
- Thick, yellow, or foul-smelling discharge
- Obvious pain, or won't let you near the ear
- Sutures that appear to be loosening or opening

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **1–2 weeks** after adoption to recheck the ear and assess healing.

Bring your adoption paperwork so your veterinarian knows the treatment already performed.